First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

FIRST CONGREGATIONAL CHURCH VISION STATEMENT

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

FIRST CONGREGATIONAL CHURCH MISSION STATEMENT

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: 8 AM to 11 AM weekdays.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: T-W-F, 9am-12pm
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

OUR WORSHIP SERVICE IS BROADCAST OVER THE LOCAL PUBLIC ACCESS CHANNEL 1079 ON SUNDAYS AT 4 PM.

SCRIPTURE READER: ALAN SHANNON

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"WE WELCOME YOU AND SERVE ALL THROUGH FAITH."

WORSHIP WITH US:

SEPTEMBER 4, 2022

10AM

REV. JESSICA MOORE, PASTOR
ERIN GRAINGER, MUSIC AND CHORAL DIRECTOR
STEPHAN CONRADY, ORGANIST
SUE POWERS, ADMINISTRATIVE ASSISTANT
27 CHURCH STREET, ST. ALBANS, VT 05478
802-524-4555

INFO@FIRSTCONGREGATIONALSTALBANS.ORG
WWW.FIRSTCONGREGATIONALSTALBANS.ORG

WE GATHER AS GOD'S PEOPLE

CENTERING WORDS**:**
"Letting go gives us freedom, and freedom is the only condition for happiness. If, in our heart, we still cling to anything – anger, anxiety, or possessions – we cannot be free." — Thich Nhat Hanh

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude

WELCOME AND ANNOUNCEMENTS

CALL TO WORSHIP[1]

One: Like clay, we arrive at this time of worship:

Many: Shapeless and full of potential, we arrive.

One: Like clay, we prepare for this time of worship:

Many: Stretched and twisted into formation, we prepare.

One: Like clay, we enter this time of worship:

Many: Formed and ready for warmth, we enter.

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*PLEASE STAND IF YOU ARE ABLE

[1]UCC, WORSHIP WAYS

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Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and a full pantry, fridge, and freezer stock of food.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:

- Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
- First Congregational Church of St Albans
- Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
- Sheldon Methodist Food Shelf
- Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
- As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative.

WH works with local housing case workers from:

- F/GI Community Action
- Voices Against Violence
- Samaritan House
- Restorative Justice Center
- Pathways

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

MORNING PRAYER[1]
One: Let us pray.
Many: Loving Creator, maker of everything good, we are in your hands. Be with us now as we gather ourselves to seek your wisdom and strive to become the people you would have us be.

HYMN*
"God Is Here! As We Your People" Verses 1, 2, 4 NCH 70

PRAYER OF CONFESSION[1] **(Unison)**

Unlike clay, we actively resist the diverse ways you shape us into what the world needs. We frequently struggle to trust in your vision for who we could become. We anxiously avoid facing the heat that protects and sustains us. We humbly confess to these and all our shortcomings.

PAUSE FOR REFLECTION

WORDS OF ASSURANCE

PASSING OF THE PEACE

THE MESSAGE
SPECIAL MUSIC
SCRIPTURE READING
Jeremiah 18:1-11
Luke 14:25-33

MORNING REFLECTION

"Re-Formed"

HYMN*

"Let Us Break Bread Together" All Verses NCH 330

THE COMMUNION Blue Binder

THE THANKSGIVING

SHARING OUR JOYS AND CONCERNS

PRAYER OF THE PEOPLE ~

THE DEPARTURE

HYMN*

"Let There Be Peace On Earth" BB 35

BENEDICTION

POSTLUDE

ANNOUNCEMENTS:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- Thank You, Mara Vijups for last week's beautiful flower arrangement for the altar.

Breakfast Church, Sept 11, 10am

Please join us for this casual worship service! We will worship in the Chapel while sharing breakfast. We will pray, praise, share, and sing over pancakes and coffee!
All ages welcome!

September 11th Informational Meeting:

Notice is hereby given that an Informational Meeting of the First Congregational Church of St. Albans, Vermont will be held on September 11, 2022 immediately following the Sunday service. This notice is given in accordance with the provisions of Article V, section 3 providing for three Informational Meetings a year, one to be held in September, and section 5A providing for two-weeks' notice for regular meetings contained in the By-Laws of the congregation.
The business for the Informational Meeting is to 1) inform the Congregation about the affairs of the church, 2) provide the opportunity to ask questions, and 3) to discuss any issues and concerns.

Bible Study is on Summer Break!

We will resume Wednesday, September 7th – please let Pastor Jessica know if you'd like to join in!

Church Street Sounds of the Season starts here in the sanctuary on September 11th at 3 PM with and organ recital. On October 9th the performance will be Music-Comp and on November 13th, Va-Et-Vient. Admission is by donation.